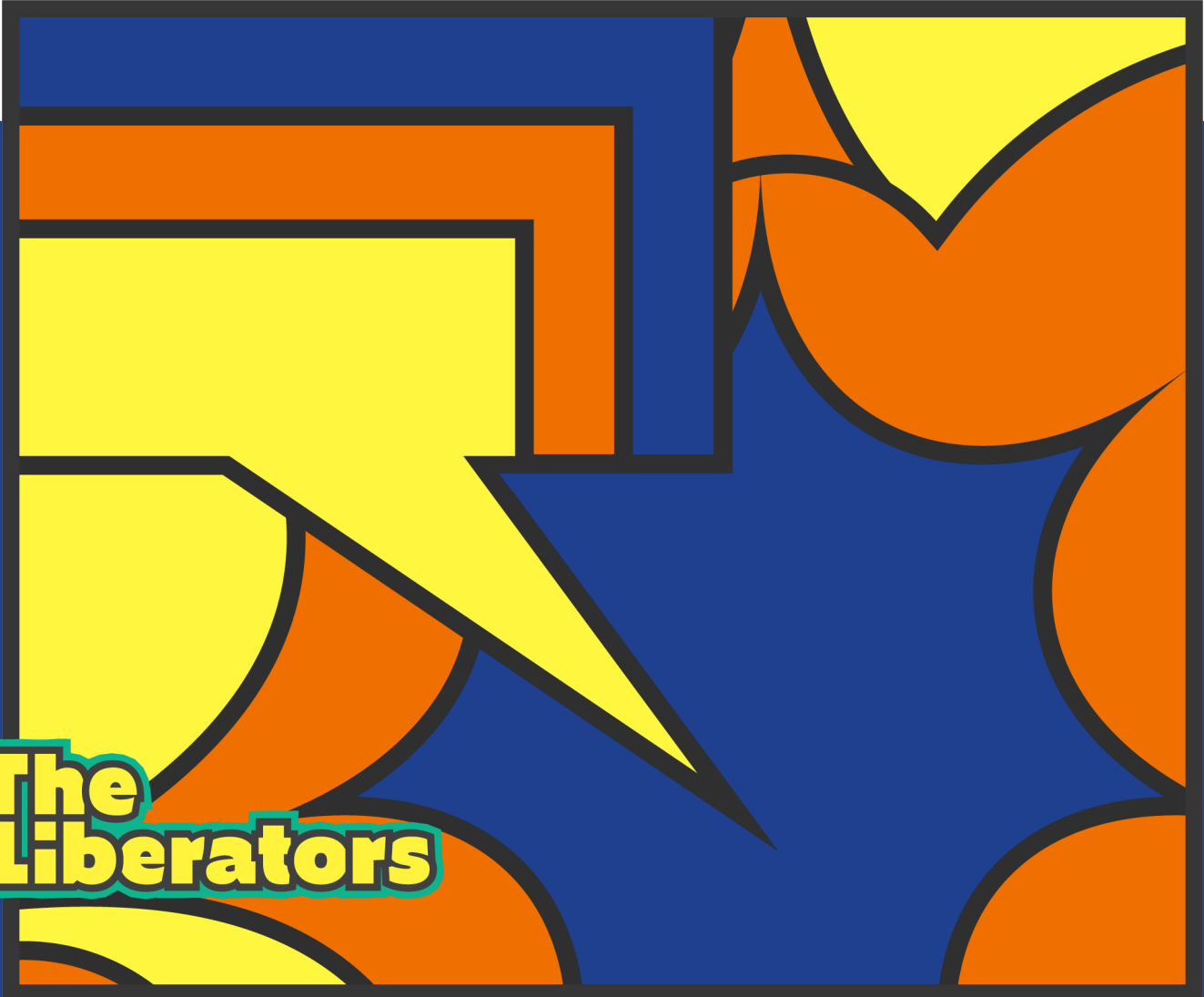


Share An Impediment Newsletter Throughout The Organization

A simple experiment to help people outside your team understand the impediments and the problems they cause

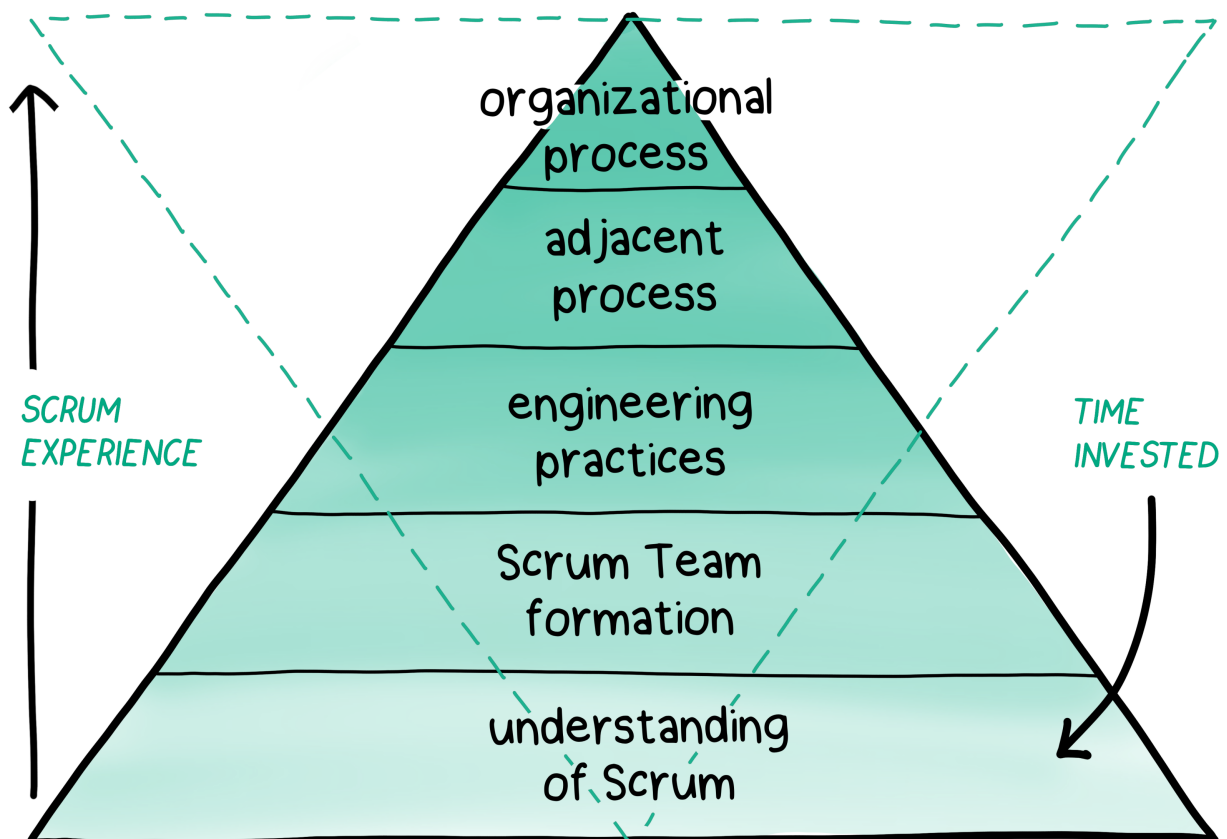


**The
Liberators**

Share an Impediment Newsletter Throughout the Organization

The impediments that make it hard for Scrum teams to work empirically often involve people across the organization. When you help them understand the impediments and the problems they cause, you create awareness about what can be improved. This, in turn, opens the door to double-loop learning and to systemic improvements.

We designed this simple experiment to help you create awareness about the problems that your team is running into. After all, if nobody else knows, nothing will ever change.



AS SCRUM TEAMS BECOME MORE EXPERIENCED
WITH SCRUM, THE PYRAMID FLIPS

model by dominik maximini



Created by Thea Schukken for the Zombie Scrum Survival Guide
by Christiaan Verwijs, Johannes Schartau & Barry Overeem
zombiescrum.org

Difficulty / Effort

Required Skill



This experiment calls for nothing but courage and a dash of tact.

Impact On Survival



Although painful, this is a great way to create urgency around the biggest problems.



Steps



To try this experiment, do the following:

1. With your Scrum team, ask everyone to silently write down impediments they see that are making it hard for them to build what stakeholders need and/or ship fast(er). What skills are missing? Where is protocol getting in the way? Which people do they need, but don't have access to? After a few minutes, invite people to pair up to share and build on their individual ideas. Together, share all impediments and pick the three to five impediments that are most impactful (e.g. with dot-voting).
2. For the biggest impediments, ask "What is lost because of this? What do we and our stakeholders gain when this impediment would be removed?". Capture the consequences of the various impediments.
3. For the biggest impediments, ask "Where do we need help? What would help look like?". Collect the requests for help for the various impediments.
4. Compile the biggest impediments, including their consequences and requests for help, in a format that you can easily distribute to everyone who has a stake in your work. It could be a mailing, a paper newsletter, a blog post on your intranet, or a poster that you put in a heavy-traffic corridor. Include the purpose of your team and how to contact you. You can also include the accomplishments of your team, of course.

Our Findings



- Make sure to include (higher) management and consider informing them upfront. Also, they will probably appreciate a shorter, more concise version.
- Transparency can be painful. Be honest but tactful in your messaging, and don't blame others or be negative. State what is happening and make clear requests for help.
- If you are planning to do this frequently, make sure to include the accomplishments of your team as well. What is going well? What has changed since the previous newsletter? And most importantly; from whom did you receive (unexpected) help?

More Resources

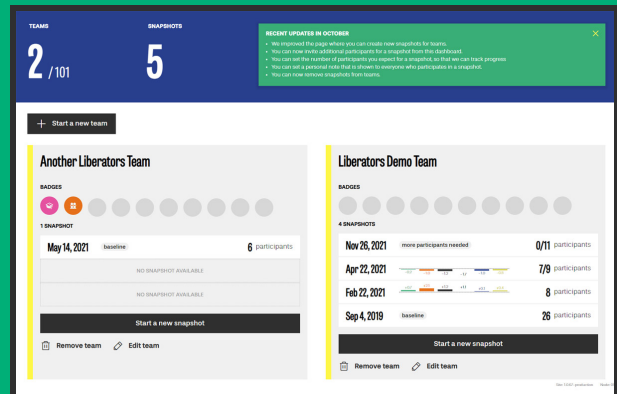
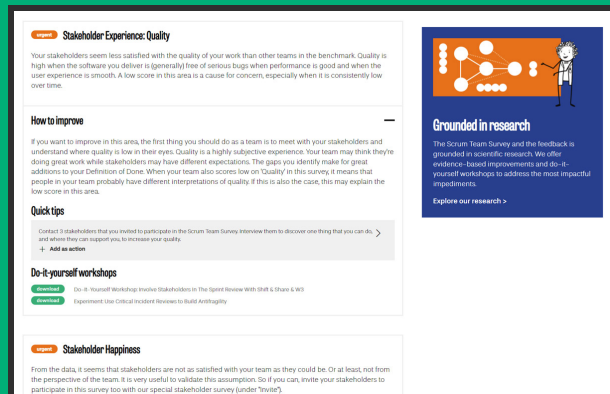
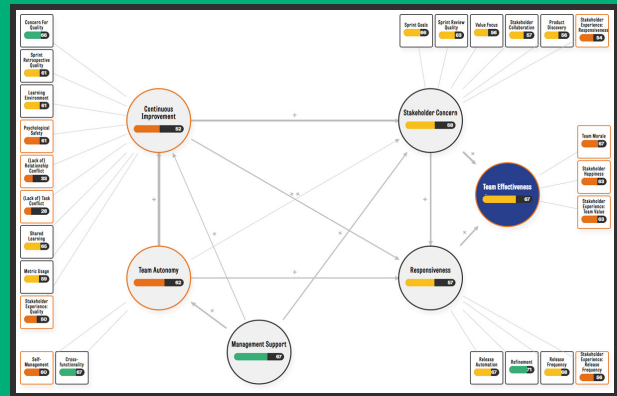
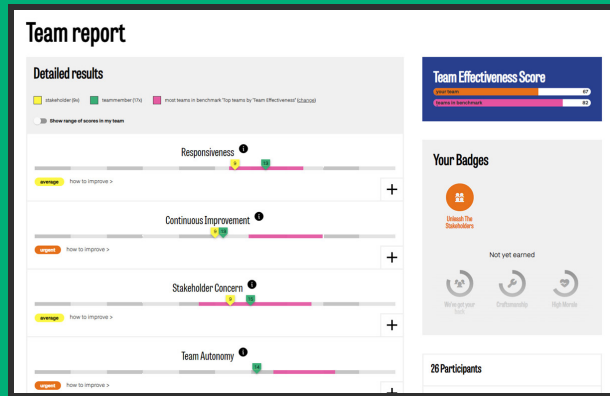


- White paper [The 8 Stances of a Scrum Master](#) with the stance of an Impediment Remover in specific
- Blog post: [Navigating Conflict, a Lifetime of Work](#)
- Blog post: [Conflict Styles: What Sciences Says](#)
- Book: [The Scrum Culture](#). The original book behind the Impediment Pyramid.
- Research: [How Do Scrum Masters Deal With Problems Outside Of Their Team's Control?](#). Together with [Age of Product](#), we asked Scrum Masters how they overcame impediments (including dependencies).



Make Your Scrum Team More Effective

Want to make your Scrum team more effective? We created the Scrum Team Survey to help. Invite members and stakeholders to a detailed questionnaire and diagnose the results together. You receive tons of actionable feedback based on your results, including dozens of quick tips and useful do-it-yourself workshops. You can use the Scrum Team Survey for free with your team. No account or e-mail address is required. You can also subscribe for more advanced features.



	Essential	Liberator
Invite team members & stakeholders	unlimited	unlimited
Quick Tips for your team per topic	3	unlimited
Recommendations to your team	5	unlimited
Compare your team against different benchmarks		✓
Analyze the range of scores in your team		✓
Receive our personal guidance on how to get started		✓
See where your team improves over time with Team Trends		✓
Support our academic research to help more teams		✓
Pricing per team per month	€ 0	€ 10

<https://scrumteamsurvey.org>

info@scrumteamsurvey.org

Unleashing Teams All Over The World

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